

Decision-making guide

Human Resource Planning

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1. Simulation platform introduction

1.1 Game Arena

The gaming arena interface comprises various decision tabs that includes the Market, Demand forecasting, Supply Forecasting, Implementation, the Decision checklist, Report, and Synopsis. Some sections must be completed first as they have an impact on other areas.

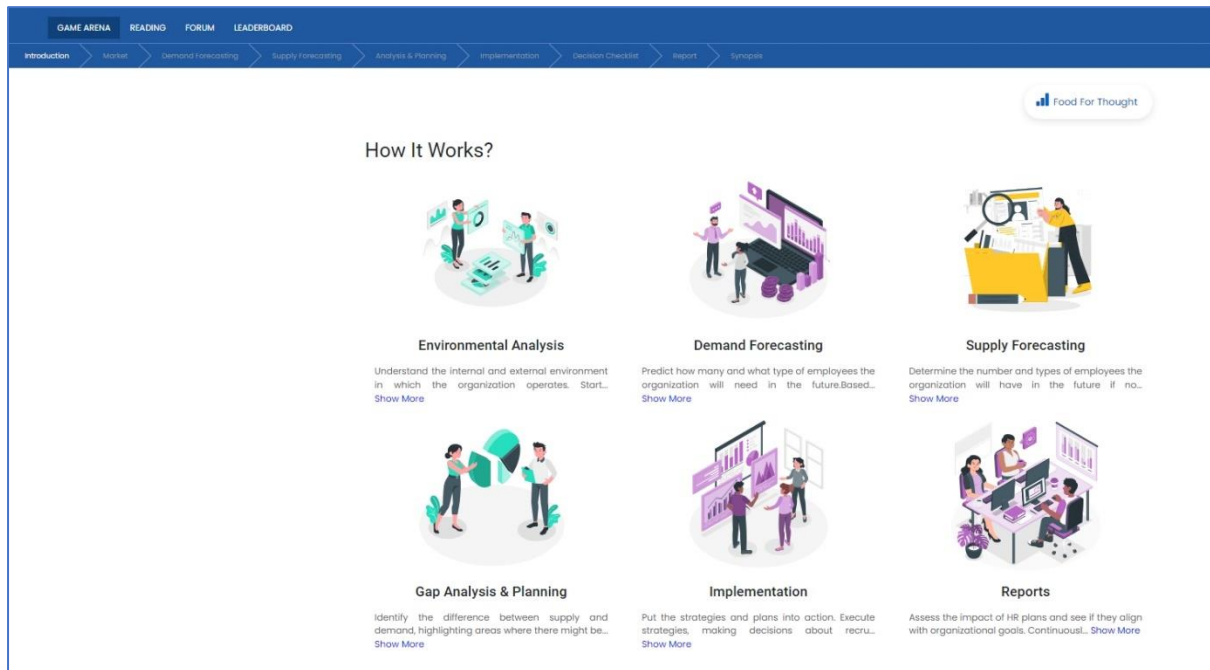


Figure 1 The Gaming Arena

1.2 Readings

This section provides essential materials necessary for participants to actively engage in the game. The main reading material consists of a guide for decision-making, supplemented by optional additional resources chosen by instructors. Moreover, a walkthrough video is accessible, offering in-depth information about the scenario featured in the simulation. This video presents insights into the case scenario, market outlook and the diverse array of decisions required.

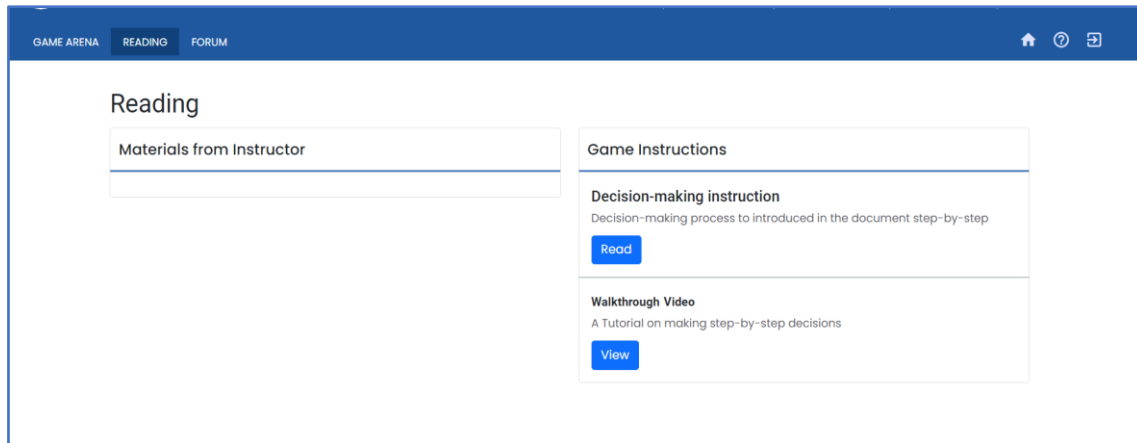


Figure 2 The Reading Section

1.3 Forum

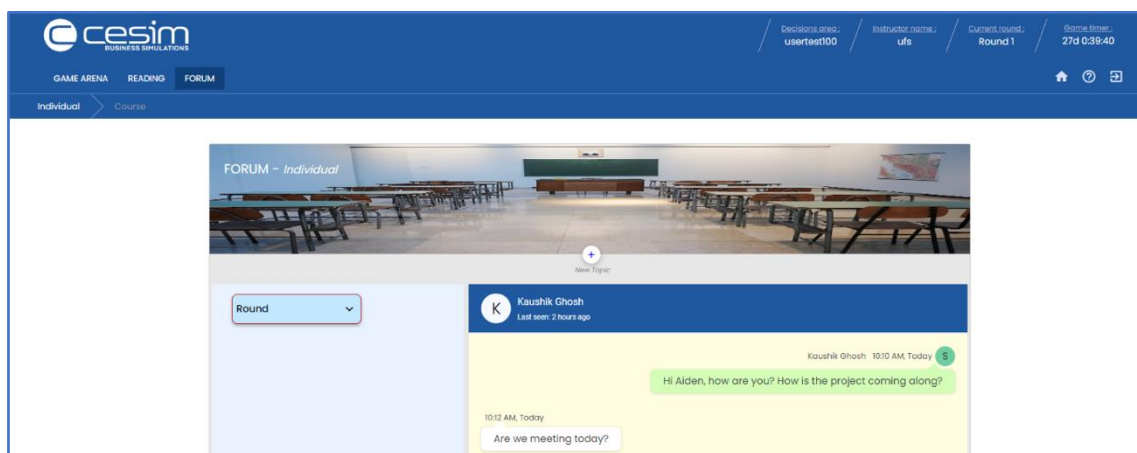


Figure 3 The Forum Section

- The forums provide an excellent platform for participants to engage with their instructors or peers.
- There are two separate forums: the Individual Forum and the Course Forum. The Individual Forum allows participants to communicate directly with the instructor, while the Course Forum is accessible to all enrolled players.
- Instructors can view and respond to posts in both sections. Consequently, the Course Forum is an appropriate space for asking questions that can benefit the entire course, while the Individual Forum is the preferred channel for the individual to have a direct discussion with the professor.
- Participants will receive notifications for messages.

1.4 Main Objective & Winning Criteria

Trendy Threads India Pvt. Ltd. is a rapidly growing e-commerce company in the fashion and clothing industry, driven by a dynamic, innovative team. Operating in a competitive market, the company focuses on leveraging cutting-edge technologies to provide a unique and customer-centric shopping experience, positioning itself as a forward-thinking brand in online fashion.

In the microsimulation, participants play a crucial role in shaping the company's success by making strategic human resource decisions. These include accurately forecasting human resources demand and supply, selecting effective hiring channels to attract talent and strengthen employer branding, and making informed decisions on compensation, training programs, and HR policies. Success hinges on participants' ability to balance workforce needs, cost management, and employee satisfaction, driving sustainable long-term growth.

1.5 Successful decision-making flow

The sequence of decision-making unfolds as follows:

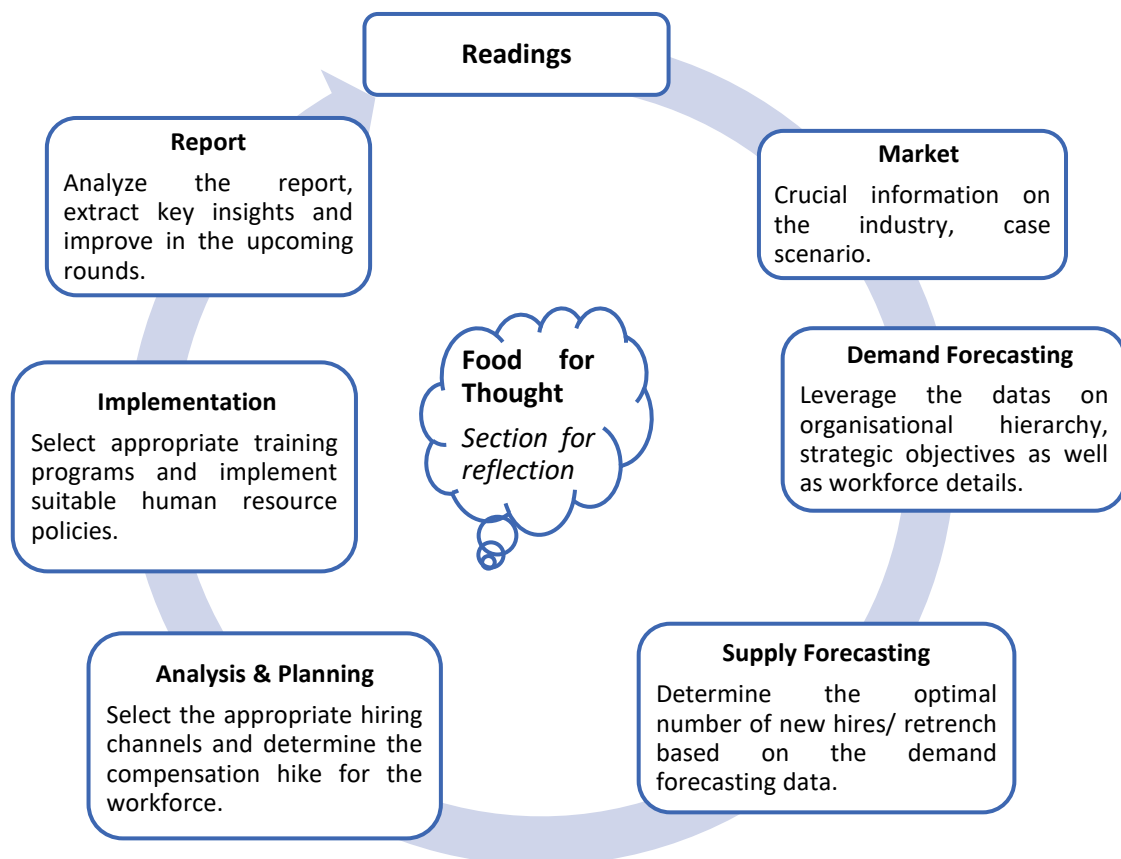


Figure 4 The Sequence of Decision-Making Process

2. Game Arena

2.1 Introduction

This page encompasses information detailing the functioning of the simulation and provides insights into each tab's decision-making.

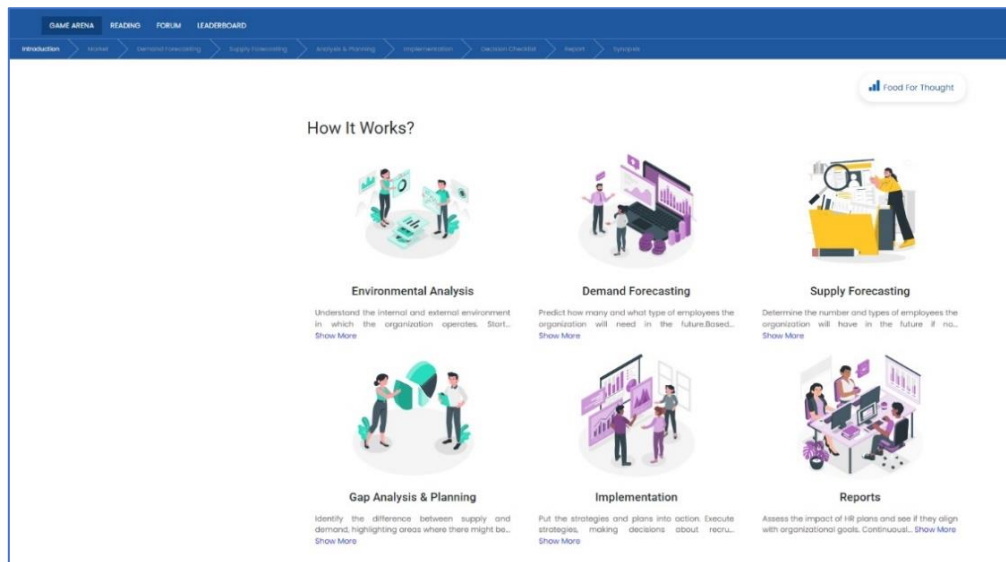


Figure 5 The Introduction Tab

2.2 Food for Thought

This segment provides crucial aspects to consider, offering valuable insights for decision-making.

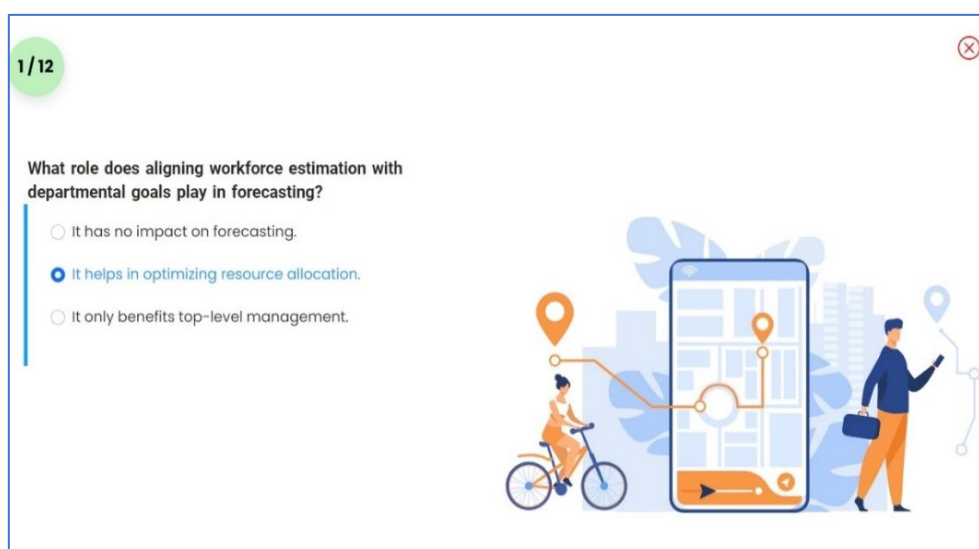


Figure 6 The food for Thought Section

2.3 Market

Prior to commencing the decision-making process, it is essential to carefully examine the "Market" section. This section offers vital information on case scenario, industry overview and the key parameters to consider when making decisions in each tab.

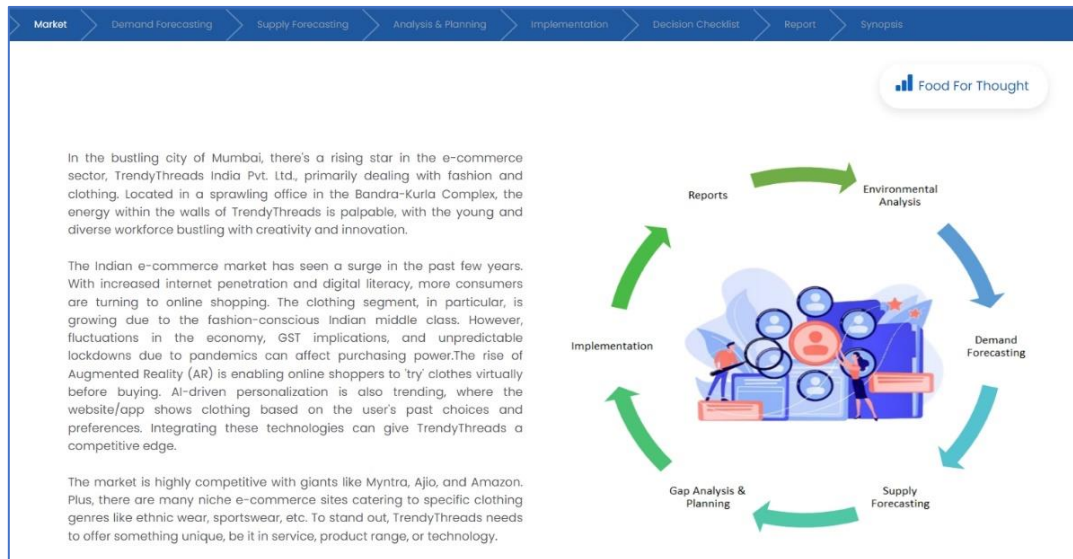


Figure 7 The Market Tab

2.4 Demand Forecasting

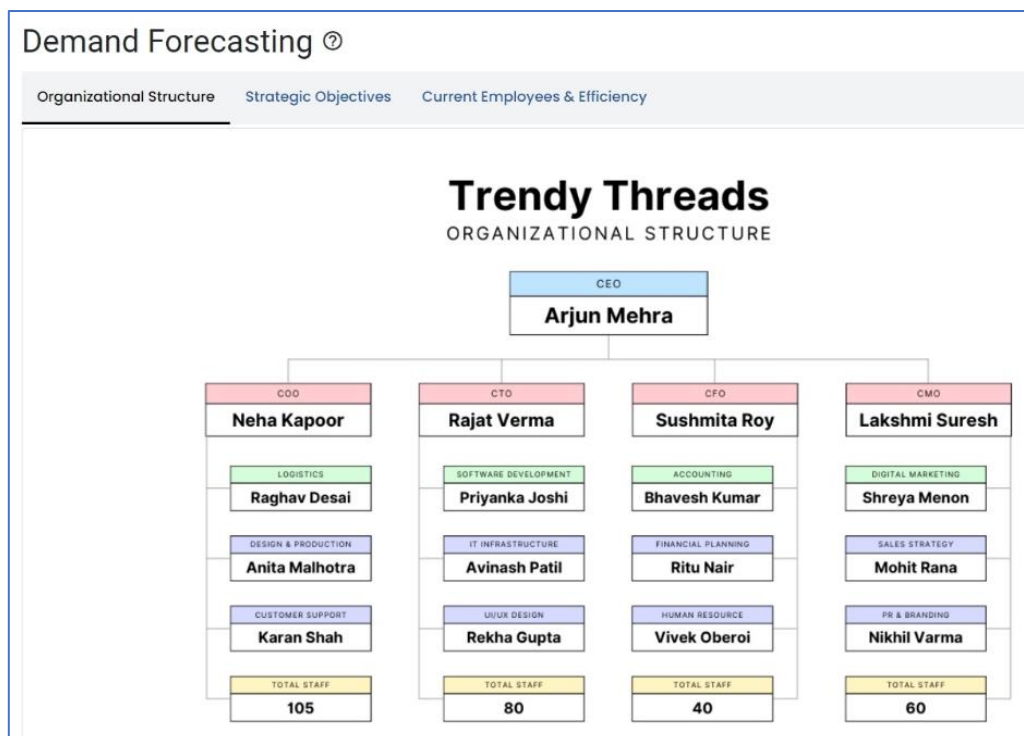


Figure 8 The Demand Forecasting tab in the game Arena

In the Demand Forecasting tab, a comprehensive overview of the organizational structure is provided, along with a clear outline of the company's strategic objectives. Additionally, detailed information about the current workforce, including the total number of employees and their efficiency levels, is included to give participants a holistic view of the resources available.



Figure 9 The Demand Forecasting tab in the Game Arena

The Strategic Objectives page outlines both current and future operational and production plans. It also highlights key technology goals, such as integrating Augmented Reality (AR) for virtual try-ons and implementing AI-driven personalized recommendations for users, all set to be achieved within the next 18 months.

Current Employees & Efficiency page gives details on the number of additional hours required in every department to achieve the strategic objective. An average employee works for 8 hours each day for 220 days. For the administration department, the standard practice is to hire 1 employee for every 10 new hires in the organization, maintaining a 1:10 ratio.



Figure 10 The Demand forecasting tab in the Game Arena

2.5 Supply Forecasting

In the Supply Forecasting tab, participants use data from the Demand Forecasting tab to identify gaps between workforce demand and supply, thereby determining whether to recruit new employees or retrench existing staff. These decisions should be guided by key metrics, including attrition rates, promotion rates, internal transfer rates, voluntary resignations, employee satisfaction scores, and the time required to fill vacant positions.

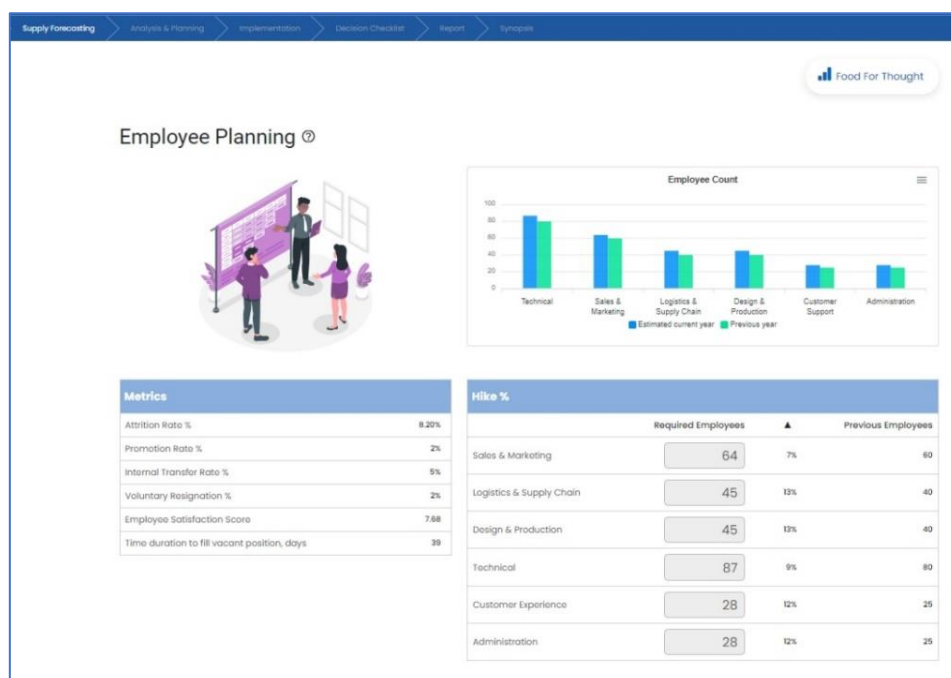


Figure 11 The Supply forecasting tab in Game Arena

2.6 Analysis & Planning

In the Analysis and Planning tab, participants are tasked with selecting appropriate hiring channels to address the human resource gap and recruit new hires. They must assess factors such as cost, benefits, and the ability to meet hiring deadlines. It is essential to choose platforms that provide maximum visibility for job listings, thereby enhancing employer branding. Additionally, these platforms should align with the company's values and effectively attract the target talent pool.

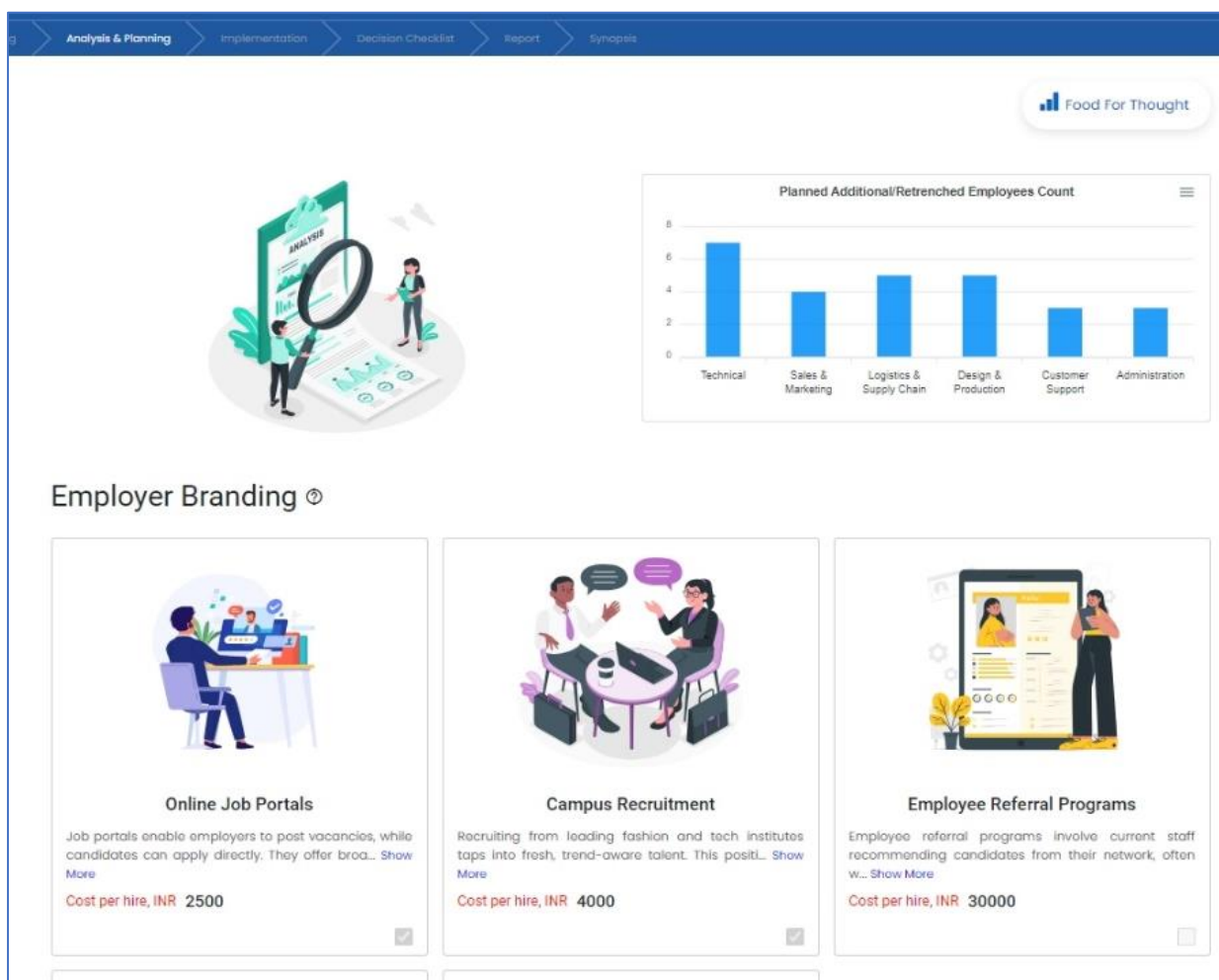


Figure 12 The Analysis & Planning in the Game Arena

2.7 Implementation

In the Implementation tab, participants are tasked with selecting training priorities tailored to the specific needs of each department, with each option having its own distinct effects. Balancing these priorities with cost considerations is crucial. Additionally, participants are responsible for choosing policies that promote long-term employee well-being and satisfaction.

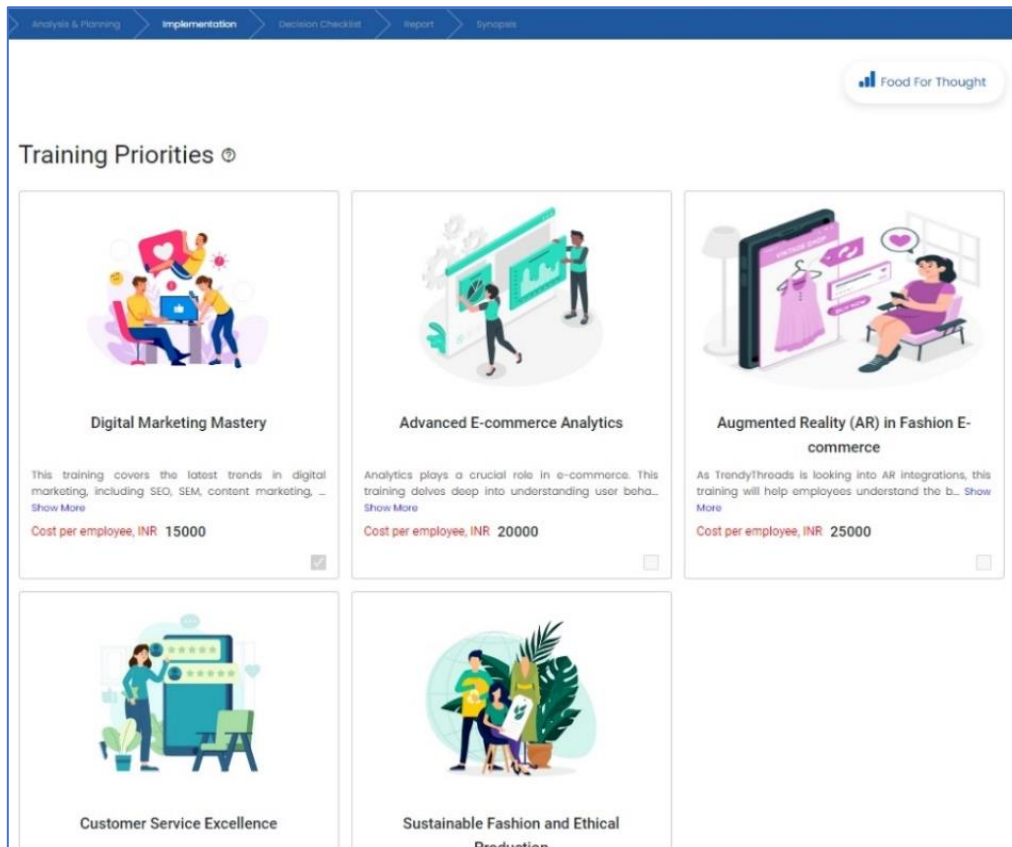


Figure 13 Training Priorities Decision Area in the Implementation Tab of Game Arena

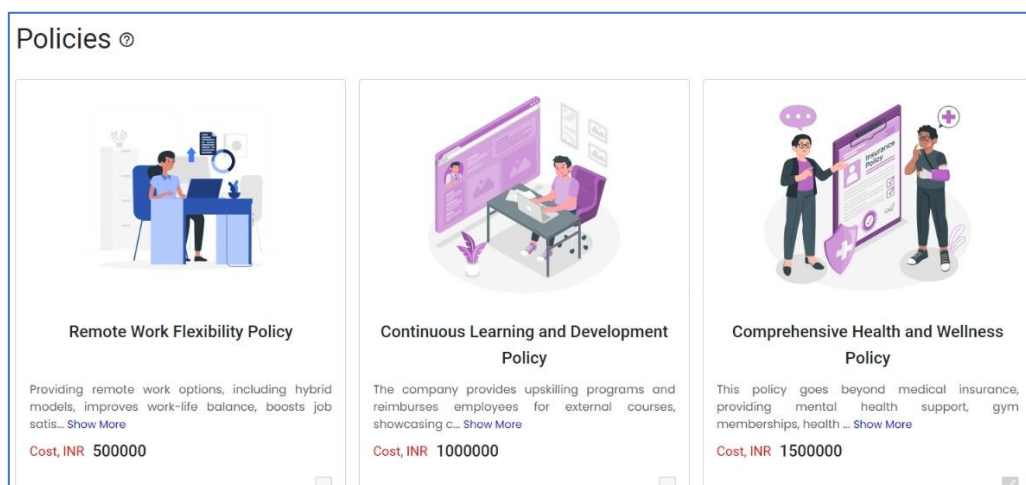


Figure 14 Policies Decision Area in the Implementation Tab of Game Arena

2.8 Decision Checklist

The Decision Checklist helps participants review and finalize their decisions. Once decisions are confirmed, they can submit them using the "Submit" option and choose **save and proceed**. It's important to note that once decisions are submitted and saved, they cannot be altered for that round. This ensures that decisions are carefully considered before finalization, promoting clarity and accountability in the decision-making process.

Analysis & Planning
Implementation
Decision Checklist
Report
Synopsis

Decision Checklist

Round 1 ▼

Supply Forecasting	User
Sales & Marketing	64
Logistics & Supply Chain	45
Design & Production	45
Technicals	87
Customer Experience	28
Administration	28
Analysis & Planning	
Online Job Portals	Yes
Campus Recruitment	Yes
Employee Referral Programs	No
Social Media and Company Website	No
Recruitment Agencies and Headhunters	Yes
Sales & Marketing, New Joiner Hike %	9
Logistics & Supply Chain, New Joiner Hike %	8
Design & Production, New Joiner Hike %	8
Technical, New Joiner Hike %	7
Customer Experience, New Joiner Hike %	7
Administration, New Joiner Hike %	8
Sales & Marketing, Existing Employee Hike %	10
Logistics & Supply Chain, Existing Employee Hike %	9
Design & Production, Existing Employee Hike %	8
Technical, Existing Employee Hike %	8
Customer Experience, Existing Employee Hike %	7

Figure 15 The Decision Checklist

2.9 Report

The report section provides the details on the participant's critical thinking abilities, demonstrates how their thought process influenced the outcomes, providing insights into the impact of their decision-making skills.

This section consists of feedback on the performance of the participant based on four metrics.

- **Rigour:** Consistency throughout the decision-making and recommendation.
- **Structuring:** Logical approach of gathering and analysing information
- **Synthesis:** Approach towards interpreting information and making informed decisions
- **Business Judgement:** Ability to evaluate facts, and consider risks and possible implications when making decisions.

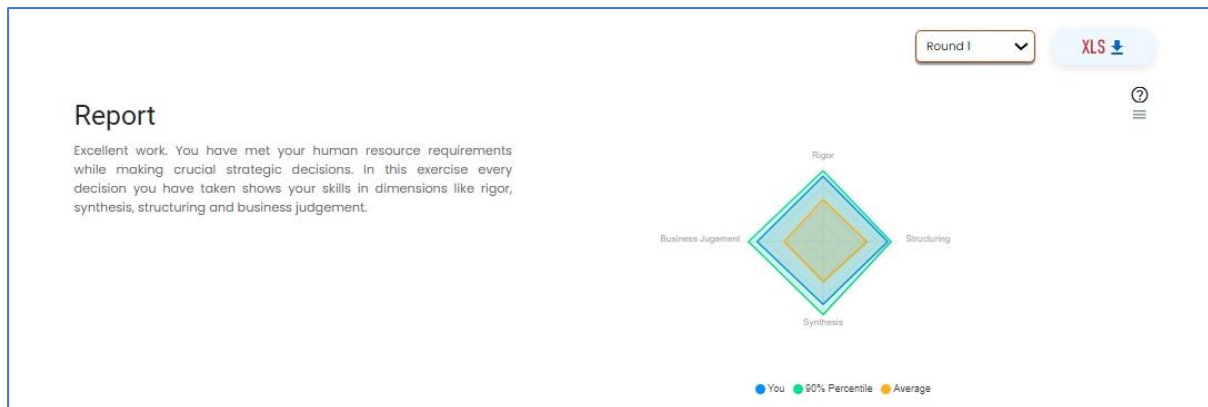


Figure 16 The Report Section

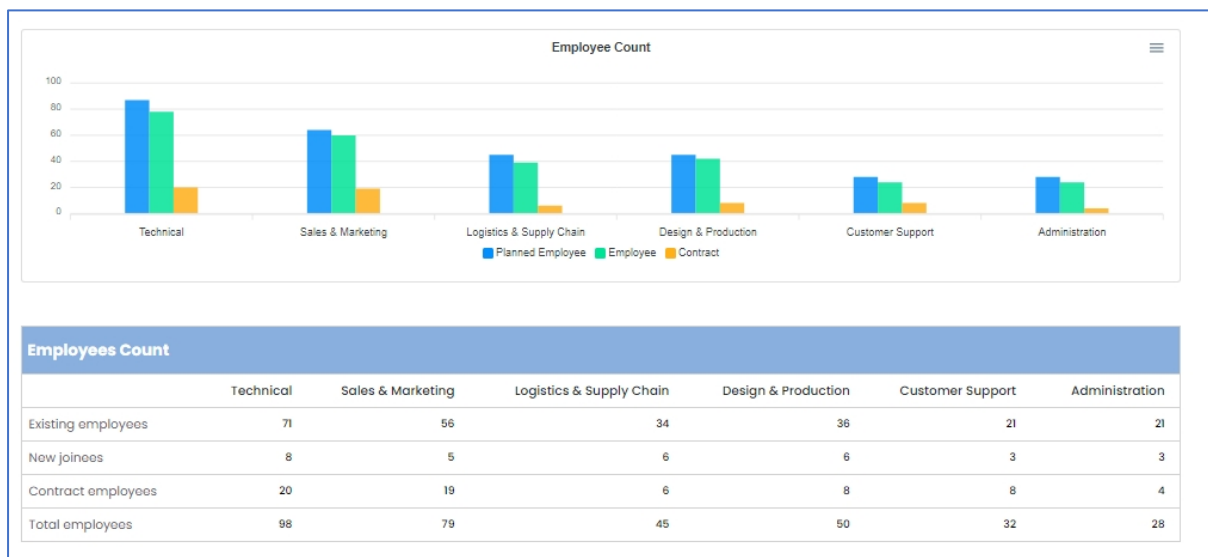


Figure 17 The Report Section

In the Report section, participants can review the employee count across departments based on their supply forecasting decisions. They can also view the overall costs related to hiring, training, and compensation, including employee salaries, contractual employee wages, and expenses associated with branding, training, and policy implementation.

The key performance indicators (KPIs) for evaluating performance are as follows:

Employee Satisfaction Score

This score reflects overall employee contentment and is influenced by several factors, including compensation hikes, training programs, and implemented policies. A higher satisfaction score indicates that employees feel valued, supported, and motivated. Providing better compensation, tailored training, and thoughtful HR policies leads to improved satisfaction, resulting in higher retention, better performance, and increased morale.

Average Time to Fill a Position (in days)

This KPI measures the average number of days it takes to fill a vacant position, reflecting the efficiency of the chosen hiring channels. A shorter time to fill a position suggests that the recruitment process is streamlined, and the channels selected are effective at attracting suitable candidates quickly. A longer duration may indicate inefficiencies, such as using platforms that do not align with the company's needs or an overly complex hiring process.

Average Efficiency Across the Organization

This KPI represents how well employees are performing relative to the goals of the organization. A higher average efficiency score shows that supply forecasting, hiring strategies, compensation plans, and training initiatives are well-aligned with the organization's needs. When these elements are effectively managed, employee productivity and overall organizational performance improve. Conversely, inefficient planning in any of these areas can negatively impact overall efficiency.

Employee Participation in Training

This percentage reflects the proportion of employees who have participated in training programs. Higher participation indicates that the training options provided are meeting the diverse needs of different departments. A well-structured training program that addresses specific departmental requirements can improve skills, adaptability, and performance across the organization. Conversely, low participation may suggest a mismatch between the offered training and the employees' perceived needs or schedules.

Cost Per Employee

This metric calculates the total cost associated with each employee, including salaries, benefits, training, and recruitment expenses. It helps in determining how efficiently the organization is managing its workforce in relation to its budget. A high cost per employee may require adjustments to compensation, hiring practices, or training investments, while a lower cost can suggest an optimized balance between expenditure and productivity.

Recruitment Metrics

In the recruitment metrics, the percentage represents the proportion of employees hired through the selected channels. A higher percentage indicates greater recruitment efficiency, with 100% signifying that all positions were filled through the chosen channels. A percentage below 100% suggests that some positions were not filled through the selected channels and may have been filled with contractual employees instead.

A lower percentage indicates potential challenges in the recruitment process, such as ineffective channel choices, mismatches between supply and demand, or unforeseen issues that hindered the full use of the selected methods. This suggests that the recruitment strategy may require refinement or adjustment to enhance overall efficiency.

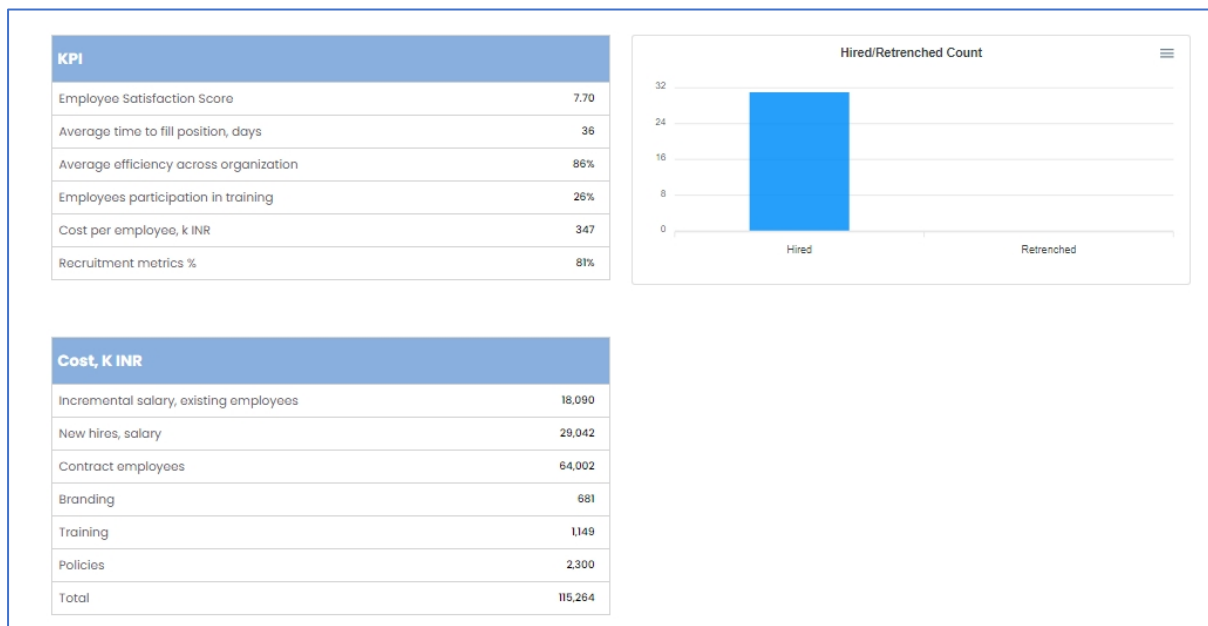


Figure 18 The Report Section

2.10 Synopsis

The synopsis section offers a concise summary of key decision areas and outcomes, highlighting critical insights including the KPI achieved and strategic directions taken during the simulation, facilitating comprehensive understanding and future planning.

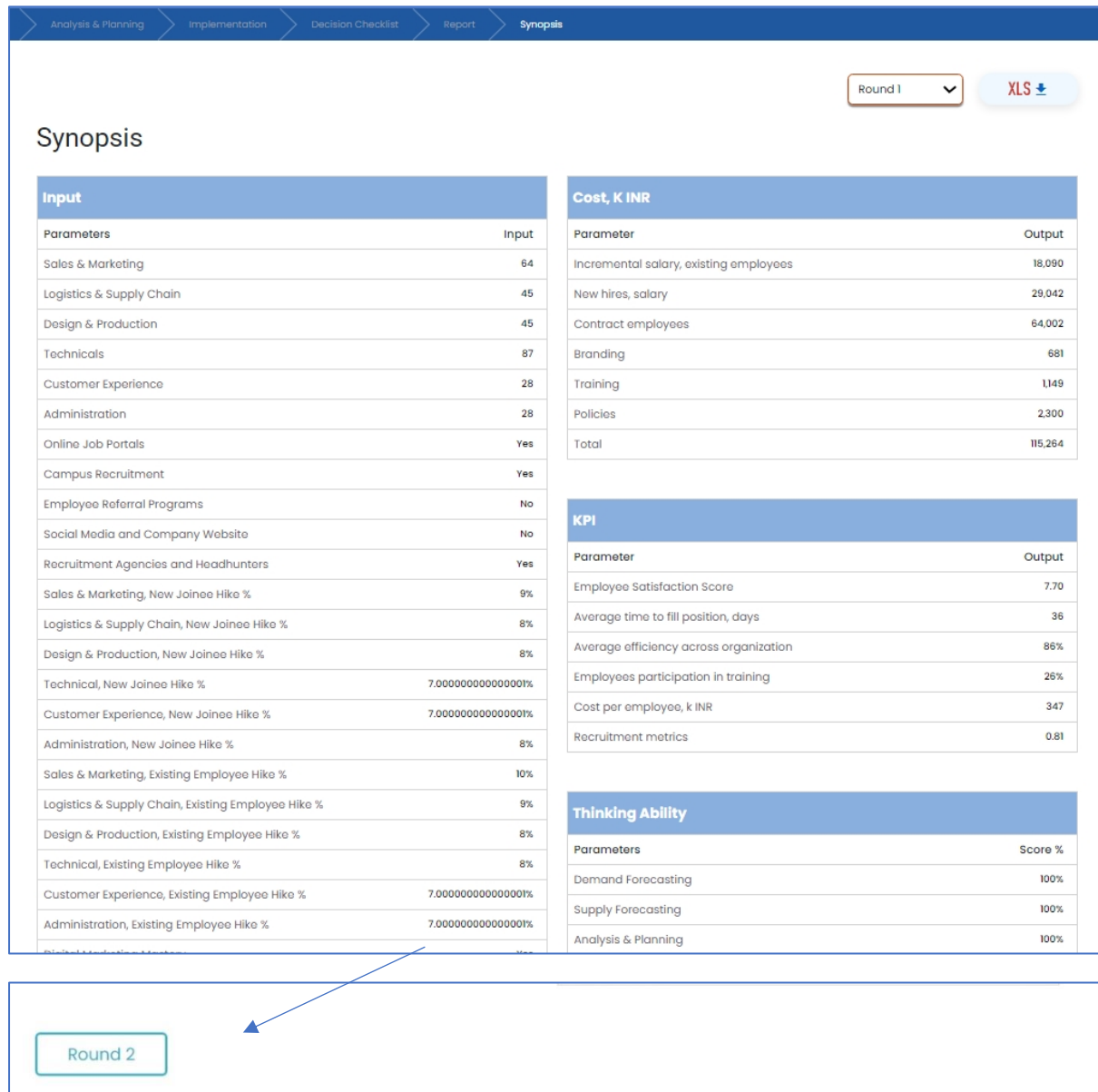


Figure 19 The Synopsis

To proceed to the next round, click on the “next round” at the bottom of the synopsis section. This will redirect participants to the home page, where they can access the next round by clicking on the corresponding card.